expanded next in the areas of Kolar, Gulbarga and Bellary.[76] By 1998, virtually all of the Karnataka coast, from Belgaum in the north to Mysore in the south, was saffron. Despite a major dip in 1999 (when the party was reduced to just seven seats), the BJP has remained a dominant state party in all the national elections since (see Table 15.2). However, in contrast to its dominance in parliamentary elections in four successive elections in Karnataka (2004–2019), it had never managed to win a full majority in provincial elections until 2018, although it did emerge as the single largest party in 2004, 2008 and 2018 and formed the state government then (see Table 15.3).

Table 15.2: The BJP in Karnataka: Lok Sabha Elections (1980–2019)

Year	*Lok Sabha Elections: Party-wise Details (Total Seats: 28)*	*BJP's Inflection Points*
1980	Congress: 27; Janata Party: 1	No BJP wins, Congress dominant
1984	Congress: 24; Janata Party: 4	No BJP wins, Congress dominant
1989	Congress: 26; Janata Dal: 2	No BJP wins, Congress dominant
1991	Congress: 23, BJP: 4, Janata: 1	First BJP breakthrough, a year after the Veerendra Patil sacking
1996	Janata Dal: 16; BJP: 6; Congress: 5; KCP: 1	Slight expansion by BJP, Janata Dal replaces Congress as the leading party
1998	NDA: 16	The first time that the BJP wins a majority of